

BONUS #5 — Pass KDP First Time

Upload Checklist + Rejection Fix Guide

Product: KDP Mafia

Perceived value: \$47

Goal: Upload once, pass Print Previewer, avoid the rejection loop

Use after: You generate files in KDP Mafia (Bonus #1)

Why books get rejected (simple truth)

Amazon isn't trying to bully you.

Most failures come from mismatches:

- Trim size doesn't match
- Cover built for wrong page count
- Content too close to edges
- Low-quality / misleading listing
- Incomplete or wrong file uploaded

KDP Mafia builds Amazon-friendly files — this guide is your **human final pass**.

How to use this guide

1. Run **Part 1** before every upload
2. Follow **Part 2** upload flow
3. If errors appear, jump to **Part 3** fixes
4. Only publish after **Part 4** green light

Print Part 1 + Part 4 and keep them beside your desk.

Part 1 — Pre-upload checklist

A) Files from KDP Mafia

- ☐ Interior PDF downloaded (final version)
- ☐ Cover PDF / wraparound downloaded
- ☐ Page count written down
- ☐ Trim size written down
- ☐ Files stored in a named folder
- ☐ You're not uploading an old version by mistake

Folder example:

```
KDP-Mafia / Cats-Word-Search-v1 /  
  interior.pdf  
  cover.pdf  
  notes.txt
```

B) Specs that must match everywhere

Setting	KDP Mafia	Interior file	Cover file	KDP form
Trim size	☐	☐	☐	☐
Page count	☐	☐	☐	☐
Interior type (B&W / color)	☐	☐	—	☐
Bleed on/off	☐	☐	☐	☐
Paper (white/cream)	—	—	—	☐

If any box disagrees, stop and fix before upload.

C) Interior quality scan (2–5 minutes)

Flip through the PDF:

- ☐ First page looks intentional
- ☐ No surprise blank pages in the middle
- ☐ Puzzles/text not cut off
- ☐ Margins feel safe
- ☐ Page numbers don't collide with content (if present)
- ☐ Answer key present and readable (puzzle books)
- ☐ Kids content looks age-appropriate
- ☐ Low-content pages still look designed (not empty spam)

D) Cover quality scan

- ☐ Title readable at thumbnail size
- ☐ Book type readable
- ☐ Niche visually obvious
- ☐ Author name correct
- ☐ No important text in barcode area
- ☐ Spine text only if page count supports it
- ☐ No blurry / stretched artwork
- ☐ No trademarks / logos / celebrity faces

E) Listing honesty scan

- ☐ Title matches contents
 - ☐ Age range matches contents
 - ☐ Description doesn't overclaim
 - ☐ No brand IP
 - ☐ Keywords relevant (Bonus #4)
-

Part 2 — Paperback upload flow (step by step)

1. Go to kdp.amazon.com
2. Create → Paperback
3. Enter language, title, subtitle, author
4. Paste description (Bonus #4 framework)
5. Set publishing rights
6. Choose 2 categories
7. Fill all 7 keywords
8. Set age/grade if needed
9. Continue to print options
10. Select trim size / ink / paper to match your files
11. Upload manuscript (interior PDF)
12. Upload cover
13. Launch **Print Previewer**
14. Inspect cover wrap + interior thoroughly
15. Fix issues → re-upload → preview again
16. Set territories + pricing
17. Publish (or save draft if account/tax still pending)

Part 2B — Safe starter settings

Use these until you know better:

Choice	Safer default
Format	Paperback first
Trim	8.5×11 for puzzles/coloring; 6×9 for journals
Interior	Black & white for puzzles/journals
Color	Only when coloring/art needs it
Bleed	Off for most puzzle/text; on for edge-to-edge art
Pages	40–80 (comfortably above minimum)
Price	\$6.99–\$9.99 to start

KDP paperbacks generally need at least **24 pages**. Don't cut it close on day one.

Part 3 — Common rejections & exact fixes

Error 1 — Trim size / manuscript size mismatch

What it means: Interior PDF size ≠ trim selected in KDP.

Fix:

1. Check notes for intended trim
2. Confirm KDP Mafia export trim
3. Re-generate/re-export at correct trim if needed
4. Re-upload interior
5. Make sure KDP form trim matches

Prevent: Write trim in notes.txt before generating cover.

Error 2 — Text/images cut off or outside safe area

What it means: Content too close to edges, or bleed expected but missing.

Fix:

1. Identify if the book should have bleed (full-bleed coloring) or not
2. Regenerate with standard/safe settings in KDP Mafia
3. Don't randomly "scale to fit" in unknown PDF tools
4. Re-preview

Prevent: For text/puzzle books, keep content clearly inside margins.

Error 3 — Cover size incorrect / spine width wrong

What it means: Cover was built for a different page count or trim.

Fix:

1. Note final interior page count after generation
2. Regenerate cover in KDP Mafia using that exact count + trim
3. Replace cover file
4. Preview wraparound carefully

Prevent: Never reuse an old cover on a longer/shorter book.

Error 4 — Image quality too low

What it means: Soft, pixelated, or stretched images.

Fix:

1. Regenerate cover/pages in KDP Mafia
2. Avoid enlarging tiny images in editors
3. Use tool-native exports
4. Re-upload

Prevent: Don't screenshot pages and upload screenshots as interiors.

Error 5 — Blank pages / missing content

What it means: Incomplete generation or bad download.

Fix:

1. Re-open preview in KDP Mafia
2. Confirm generation finished
3. Download fresh files
4. Re-upload

Prevent: Wait for job completion before downloading.

Error 6 — Hard-to-read text

What it means: Tiny fonts, low contrast, busy backgrounds.

Fix:

1. Use large-print / beginner settings where claimed
2. Simplify cover: big title, high contrast
3. Remove fancy fonts that break at small sizes

Prevent: Do the thumbnail test before upload.

Error 7 — Metadata / listing rejected

What it means: Title/description/keywords violate rules or look misleading.

Fix:

1. Remove trademarks and celebrity names
2. Make title match real contents
3. Remove income/medical miracle claims
4. Resubmit

Prevent: Use Bonus #4 formulas and stay honest.

Error 8 — Wrong interior type (color vs B&W)

What it means: Color content uploaded as B&W (or opposite expectations).

Fix:

1. Decide if the book truly needs color
2. Match KDP interior type to files
3. Re-upload if necessary

Note: Color costs more and changes pricing math. Use intentionally.

Error 9 — Barcode / back cover issues

What it means: Important text where barcode sits, or messy back cover.

Fix:

1. Keep lower-right / barcode zone clean
 2. Regenerate cover if text collides
 3. Preview back cover specifically
-

Error 10 — “Something went wrong” upload failures

What it means: File corrupt, too large, browser glitch, or incomplete download.

Fix:

1. Re-download from KDP Mafia
2. Try another browser
3. Disable flaky extensions
4. Re-upload one file at a time

5. Confirm PDF opens locally first

Part 4 — Print Previewer green-light checklist

Do not publish until every box is checked:

- ☐ Previewer opens with no blocking errors
- ☐ Front cover looks correct
- ☐ Spine looks correct (or correctly blank if too thin)
- ☐ Back cover looks correct
- ☐ Barcode area clear
- ☐ First interior page correct
- ☐ Middle pages consistent
- ☐ End pages / answer key complete
- ☐ No clipped art/text in preview
- ☐ You're okay with the thumbnail look

If even one box fails → fix first.

Part 5 — Debug order when you're stuck

Change one thing at a time:

1. Confirm trim + page count match everywhere
2. Re-download fresh files from KDP Mafia
3. Re-upload interior only → preview
4. Re-upload cover only → preview
5. Regenerate cover with exact page count
6. Regenerate full book only if needed
7. Simplify listing metadata if KDP flags content policy

Frustration usually comes from changing 5 variables at once.

Part 6 — Quality bar by book type

Word Search / Sudoku / Crossword / Cryptogram

- ☐ Puzzles readable
- ☐ Answer key included
- ☐ Difficulty matches title claims
- ☐ Large print claim is true if used

Maze / Activity / Tracing / Math

- ☐ Instructions clear enough for age
- ☐ Pages not overcrowded
- ☐ Kids age label accurate

Coloring

- ☐ Lines clear
- ☐ Theme consistent
- ☐ Bleed handled correctly if art hits edges

Journal / Tracker / Log

- ☐ Pages look useful, not empty filler
 - ☐ Prompt/tracker layout consistent
 - ☐ Undated if you want longer shelf life
-

Part 7 — Pre-publish business checklist

Not a KDP error, but still important:

- ☐ Author/pen name decided
- ☐ Price set
- ☐ Royalty plan chosen (standard options in KDP)
- ☐ Categories + keywords filled
- ☐ You saved ASIN/link after publish
- ☐ You know this is paperback #1, not a 20-book night

Part 8 — Rejection journal (use when something fails)

Copy/paste for each issue:

```
Date:  
Book title:  
Trim:  
Page count:  
Error message (exact):  
What I changed:  
Re-uploaded interior? Y/N  
Re-uploaded cover? Y/N  
Previewer result after fix:  
Final status: Fixed / Still stuck
```

After 2–3 books, you'll see your personal pattern and stop repeating it.

Part 9 — Fast fixes cheat card

Symptom	Likely cause	Fastest fix
Size mismatch	Trim disagreement	Match trim everywhere
Spine weird	Wrong page count on cover	Regen cover
Edges cut off	Margin/bleed issue	Regen safe settings
Blurry art	Bad image/export	Regen in KDP Mafia
Upload fails	Corrupt/old file	Fresh download
Listing blocked	Metadata/IP issue	Clean title/desc

Part 10 — 15-minute final pass script

Use this right before publish:

Minute 1–3: Open interior PDF, flip start/middle/end

Minute 4–6: Open cover PDF, thumbnail test

Minute 7–8: Confirm trim/page count notes

Minute 9–12: Run Print Previewer

Minute 13–15: Check title/keywords/categories one last time

If clean → publish.

Part 11 — After a rejection email

1. Don't panic
2. Copy the exact reason
3. Find it in Part 3
4. Fix only that issue

5. Resubmit

6. Log it in Part 8

Most first-time issues are trim/cover/page-count mismatches — not “your account is doomed.”

Part 12 — FAQ

Q: Do I need ISBN on day one?

A: KDP can provide a free ISBN for paperbacks. Follow current KDP options in the form.

Q: Can I publish while tax interview is pending?

A: You can often prepare drafts/files; full publishing may require account setup complete.

Q: Should I use KDP Cover Creator instead?

A: Prefer your KDP Mafia cover so trim/spine stay matched to your workflow.

Q: Hardcover on day one?

A: Not necessary. Paperback first.

Q: My previewer warning seems minor.

A: Read it anyway. “Minor” warnings can still block approval.

Q: How many times should I regenerate?

A: Once for content issues, once for cover page-count sync. If still broken, simplify niche/settings.

Part 13 — Pass/Fail scorecard

Score before you hit Publish (1 point each):

- ☐ Trim matches everywhere
- ☐ Page count matches cover
- ☐ Interior preview looks clean

- ☐ Cover thumbnail readable
- ☐ Previewer has no blocking errors
- ☐ Keywords filled
- ☐ Categories selected
- ☐ Description honest
- ☐ Price set
- ☐ Files backed up locally

10/10 = publish.

8–9 = fix the missing pieces first.

Under 8 = do not publish yet.

Part 14 — One-page mantra

Pass KDP first time =

Match trim + Match page count + Preview everything + Honest listing

KDP Mafia builds the engine.

You run this checklist.

Together you avoid the rejection loop.

Final action

For your current book, complete this now:

Trim size: _____
Page count: _____
Interior file name: _____
Cover file name: _____
Previewer status: Pass / Fail
If fail, error #: ____ from Part 3
Publish decision today: Yes / Tomorrow

Appendix — Pre-flight worksheet (print this)

Book working title: _____

Book type: _____

Trim size: _____

Page count: _____

Interior file path: _____

Cover file path: _____

Bleed: On / Off

Interior type: Black & White / Color

Paper: White / Cream

Keywords filled (7/7): Yes / No

Categories selected (2): Yes / No

Previewer result: Pass / Fail

If fail, error category (Part 3 #): _____

Fix applied: _____

Second previewer result: Pass / Fail

Publish clicked: Yes / No

ASIN / link: _____

Notes for next book:

Complete one worksheet per book. After 5 books, your upload speed doubles.
